ClinicalKey Nursing AI

Prompt tips

ClinicalKey Nursing AI uses generative AI to give you trusted, evidence-based answers through conversational search. Use these tips to get the most out of it.

How should I phrase my question?

Summary	Recommendation	Caution
Give details	Ask a clinical question with patient context, nursing role, and care setting. **Example:** *How should I monitor for pain in an older adult post-op hip fracture patient with significant confusion, hearing loss, and mild dementia at baseline?*	Avoid vague keywords or single terms. They may return broad results. **Example:** *Hip fracture care*
Be specific	Ask a specific, explicitly stated nursing question. **Example:** *What should I monitor after giving IV furosemide to a patient with heart failure, and what findings should I escalate?*	Avoid broad, nonspecific questions. **Example:** *What should I monitor after giving furosemide?*
Ask like you are consulting a colleague	Phrase the question like you would ask a senior nurse, preceptor, educator, or clinical specialist. **Example:** *What are early symptoms of sepsis, and at what point should they be escalated to trigger sepsis protocols?*	Avoid traditional prompt engineering language. **Example:** *Act as an expert ICU nurse and tell me everything about sepsis.*

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How should I phrase my question? (continued)

Summary	Recommendation	Caution
Keep queries to a single topic	Try to limit the query focus to a single topic. Ask follow-up questions if you need deeper information. **Example:** *What should I prepare to assess for a patient transferring from the ED with a new diagnosis of pulmonary embolism just started on heparin?* **Follow-up with:** *What interventions would be appropriate?* *What symptoms or findings would indicate a need to escalate?*	Adding too many variables to the query can create overload when trying to identify the best references for each variable. **Example:** *What nursing assessments and interventions should I complete and when should I escalate findings for a patient with a new diagnosis of pulmonary embolism that is now on heparin?*

What type of information should I request?

Summary	Recommendation	Caution
Ask for guidance, not decisions	Ask for nursing assessments, interventions, monitoring, and escalation cues. **Example:** *My 55-year-old patient with a-fib and CHF has sudden facial droop and unilateral weakness. What interventions should be done immediately?*	Do not ask the tool to make the clinical decision for you. **Example:** *Should I call rapid response for this patient?*
Seek evidence-based guidance	Ask for evidence-based care guidance, and use the citations to verify the answer. **Example:** *What evidence-based nursing interventions help prevent pressure injuries in an immobile older adult, and what should I document?*	Do not accept the answer without reviewing citations when applying it in practice. You can click on reference links to view in full-text format within ClinicalKey Nursing.

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What type of information should I request? (continued)

Summary	Recommendation	Caution
Request medication safety information	Use it for medication safety questions within nursing scope. **Example:** *For an adult patient with COPD, diabetes, and chronic kidney disease starting antibiotics with insulin dose changes, what medication safety checks should I focus on?*	Do not use it for dose calculation, IV compatibility confirmation, or replacing pharmacy/local policy. ClinicalKey Nursing AI is currently unable to support these query types.
Use for tool's intended purpose	Use it to further your understanding of concepts or disease processes. **Example:** *How does multiple sclerosis affect patient mobility?*	Do not use to create information to provide to patients. **Example:** *What patient information should be provided to a patient with a new diagnosis of multiple sclerosis?*
Use as procedure refresher	Use it to prepare for or reinforce procedural care. **Example:** *What key steps and safety checks should I follow when inserting an indwelling urinary catheter?*	Do not use it as a substitute for competency validation or local procedure policy. **Example:** *What is our hospital policy for organ donation?*
Ask for learning support	Ask follow-up when the answer reveals a knowledge gap. **Example:** Following a query asking about different treatment options for Crohn's Disease, you might ask: *How do the side effects differ for each?*	Avoid using the AI as a substitute for protocol discovery. **Example:** *What are our policies around visitors in the ICU?*

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